

National & Gandhian Mass Movements

Swadeshi to Quit India - phases, methods, social base and PYQ discriminators.

Portion focus ~82% · Topic: hist-modern

PYQ themes: Non-Cooperation · Civil Disobedience · Quit India · Revolutionary strand · Early satyagrahas

Why this portion (PYQ lens)

Portion chance ~82%. Stable yearly; parent hist-modern ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Movement phases create decade-method matching questions.

Syllabus framing

Portion chance ~82%. Stable yearly; parent hist-modern ~85%. This portion sits inside hist-modern and centres on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements. Movement phases create decade-method matching questions.

Recurring PYQ angles: Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India, Revolutionary strand, Early satyagrahas. Approximate appearance years in the 2016-2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025. Use the chance percentage only to sequence study hours - it is not an official prediction.

Core map of nationalist and Gandhian mass movements

Moderates vs Extremists: Petition politics vs Swadeshi/passive resistance accents. Champaran 1917: Indigo satyagraha - early Gandhi laboratory.

Kheda: Revenue satyagraha. Ahmedabad mill: Labour satyagraha.

Hold this core map as your elimination spine before memorising peripheral CA overlays.

Core concepts and definitions

Rowlatt/Jallianwala: 1919 repression feeding NCM climate. NCM 1920 - 22: Boycott + Khilafat; Chauri Chaura withdrawal.

Swarajists: Council entry debate after NCM. CDM/Dandi 1930: Salt satyagraha opens Civil Disobedience.

Institutions, processes and mechanisms

Gandhi - Irwin Pact: Truce checkpoint. Round Table Conferences: Constitutional negotiation theatre.

Quit India 1942: Do or Die; leaders jailed; spontaneous activity. Revolutionary strand: HSRA/ Bhagat Singh; Surya Sen.

India angle and applied examples

INA: Subhas Bose; INA trials emotion. Women in movements: Visible participation - rising area.

Peasants/tribals: Local uprisings complementary pool. Methods lexicon: Boycott, picketing, salt, underground 1942.

Comparisons, linkages and discriminators

Social base: Students, lawyers, peasants, business vary by phase. Communal strands: Avoid monocausal Congress-only narratives.

Simon boycott: All-white commission controversy. Post-war link: Movements feed 1945 - 47 endgame without oversimplify.

India angle

Build timeline wall 1917 -> 1919 -> 1920 -> 1930 -> 1942 with method verbs.

Question patterns and exam spine

Matching lists and multi-statement questions on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements.

Revision spine: Definitions -> table -> India -> traps for nationalist and Gandhian mass movements.

Eliminate anachronisms and category errors first, then test remaining options against table rows and must-remember triggers.

Trap watch-list (specific)

Avoid: Salt March dated to NCM. Avoid: Chauri Chaura started Quit India. Avoid: Ignoring Khilafat - NCM link. Avoid: Collapsing Extremists with terrorists.

Phase sheet

Phase | Hook

Early satyagrahas -- Champaran/Kheda/Ahmedabad

NCM -- 1920 - 22 + Khilafat

CDM -- Dandi 1930

Quit India -- 1942

Revolutionary -- HSRA etc.

Common traps

x Salt March dated to NCM

x Chauri Chaura started Quit India

x Ignoring Khilafat - NCM link

x Collapsing Extremists with terrorists

Must remember

- Early satyagrahas
- NCM+Khilafat
- Chauri Chaura
- Dandi/CDM
- Quit India 1942
- INA trials

Quick revision checklist

[] Reproduce table

[] 5 must-remembers

[] 3 traps

[] India anchor

[] 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic - not an official UPSC prediction. (c) UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.